



GARY CORONADO Los Angeles Times

ONE WINE EXPERT says it may take years for the industry to grow again: “We’ve built to overproduce; we’ve got to balance that out.”

Just as uncontrollable financial, demographic and other forces have wreaked havoc in Hollywood, California’s wine industry is now reeling from epochal stresses that are grinding down yet another mainstay of the state’s economy.

The aging of baby boomers who long served as the industry’s mainstay, changing tastes among young consumers, a flood of cheaper foreign wine, a surplus of U.S. products and new medical warnings against alcohol are shaking a once seemingly impregnable business to its core. Then there’s the threat of Trump tariffs and retaliatory duties — even an outright boycott by Canada, California wine’s largest export market.

“We’re really hit by a perfect storm of crisis today,” says Natalie Collins, president of the California Assn. of Winegrape Growers.

WINE MARKET ADJUSTS TO A NEW REALITY

California sellers struggle with changing tastes, foreign competition and too many grapes on the vine

By Don Lee

After nearly three decades of annual growth, U.S. wine sales and shipments have fallen into a prolonged slump.

Gone are the days when international acclaim for Napa and other California products seemed to promise an endlessly bright future. Now, thousands of grapevines are being destroyed because there’s no market for their grapes.

There was a brief reprieve when consumers stuck at home during the COVID-19 pandemic flocked to wine clubs and sparked online buying binges. Tasting rooms that once entertained masses of customers are now struggling to survive. Those good times seem to be fading fast.

And looking beyond its present woes, the industry faces tectonic shifts in demographics that suggest [See Wine, A7]

A push to remake cannabis agency

Amid safety fears, calls mount to curb authority of state department in charge of pot oversight.

By PAIGE ST. JOHN

Criticism that California is failing to fully address contamination in its weed crop has prompted a push for the governor and lawmakers to step in and remove that authority from the state agency in charge.

The Santa Cruz County Board of Supervisors last month asked the governor and Legislature to shift responsibility for pesticides in cannabis products from the Department of Cannabis Control to the state Department of Pesticide Regulation, which regulates pesticides on food crops. It requested that accreditation of cannabis testing labs be moved to the State Water Resources Control Board, which already certifies private labs to test food, water, soil and hazardous waste. And it asked that the state [See Cannabis, A10]



AL SEIB For The Times

RAW GARDEN’S co-founder, Thomas Martin, with his cannabis crops. Pesticide tests Martin funded confirmed widespread contamination in top cannabis brands.

Amid outbreak, parents weigh ‘bonus dose’ of measles vaccine

After a death in west Texas, a shot may be appropriate in some situations, doctors say.

By SONJA SHARP AND JENNY GOLD

Like many anxious parents, Beth Spektor spent the last few weeks fretting over how to protect her infant daughter from the first deadly measles outbreak to hit the U.S. in a decade.

Her 9-month-old was too

young for the first dose of the measles, mumps and rubella vaccine, typically given to American toddlers shortly after their first birthday.

But when her New Jersey mommy WhatsApp group started buzzing about an early bonus dose of MMR for babies, Spektor decided to ask her pediatrician for one anyway.

“I was assuming she would say, ‘It’s up to you,’ or ‘It’s not a bad idea,’ something a little less definitive,” the mother said.

Instead, the doctor urged her to take the extra jab, a

move they recommended to all infant patients after three linked cases were reported in their region.

The doctor “said she was hoping that [U.S. Secretary of Health and Human Services Robert F. Kennedy Jr.] would change the schedule to recommend that all babies over 6 months get the bonus dose,” Spektor said.

That’s unlikely, experts say. Despite the current outbreak, measles is still rare in the U.S., and while MMR is safe for babies as young as 6 months, it’s more effective in [See Measles, A5]

Trump waging 1% policy wars

Critics say president is stoking fear on USAID, fentanyl and transgender people to score political points. **NATION, A4**

DWP chief seeks private security

Board will decide Tuesday whether to approve a one-year contract to protect CEO amid threats. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Clouds and sunshine. L.A. Basin: 67/50. **B5**

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MICHAEL CONROY Associated Press

BRUINS WIN BIG TEN TITLE

UCLA’s Janiah Barker blocks a shot by USC’s JuJu Watkins in the 72-67 victory in the tournament championship in Indianapolis. **SPORTS, D1**



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